strong revival of the India–US strategic partnership, driven by Modi and Trump, has been energised by the promise of a more robust US approach to China. The Trump administration has reasserted the US commitment to a free and open Indo-Pacific and has strongly criticised China's "predatory economics," "technology theft," and military overreach.[16] The US National Security Strategy (2017) promises sustained US leadership in a collective response to Chinese actions threatening the sovereignty of Indo-Pacific countries. The United States has targeted the Chinese telecommunications and consumer electronics giant Huawei as the poster boy of technology theft and warned its allies against Chinese-built 5G systems.

From India's perspective, the negative fallout of the Russia-West standoff on India–Russia relations was exacerbated by the progressive strengthening of Russia–China cooperation. Sino–Russian relations had already started warming in the early 2000s, with the amicable settlement of their long-standing border disputes. The Chinese demand for Russian natural resources, raw materials, and military technologies created economic complementarities. There were political convergences, too, in their opposition to Western ideas of democracy propagation, humanitarian intervention, and regime change. However, conscious of their adversarial past and concerned about Chinese intellectual property rights (IPR) theft through reverse engineering, Russia had exercised reserve in transfers of the latest weapons systems and technologies to China. Russia was also careful about the Chinese presence in its Far East, a region that was Chinese until the mid-19th century. This restraint nevertheless weakened as Russia–West relations worsened and China's political and economic support became more valuable. China has now invested in liquefied natural gas (LNG) projects in Russia's Arctic region. Chinese farmers have been leased land for agricultural